

The Question of Ultimate Reality (dhamma) Key philosophical and ethical concepts: • The nature of Ultimate Reality in Buddhism • The existence of evil in the world • Human suffering	• Buddhist understandings of the concept of Ultimate Reality, including: ◦ Different Buddhist teachings and beliefs about the nature of Ultimate Reality ◦ Different Buddhist teachings and beliefs about the nature of the world and humanity ◦ The relationship between humanity, the world and Ultimate Reality ◦ Reasons for different views • Buddhist beliefs and views on the role of skilful action in relation to questions of goodness • Buddhist beliefs and views on the relationship of nibbana and goodness	• Dhammapada v188 the Buddha states that people created God because they live in a world of fear and danger • The six realms of existence – the higher realms contain gods • Mahayana cosmology: ◦ The different Buddha worlds, such as Amida Buddha's Pure Land and the eternal Nature of Amida Buddha
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	• Buddhist understandings of the meaning of goodness in the context of the actions of the buddhas, bodhisattvas and arhats • Buddhist beliefs, teachings and views on the relationship between Ultimate Reality and human suffering • Whether the experience of suffering is related to the existence of evil Learners should be aware of the justifications Buddhists give for different views, attitudes and understandings, from the perspectives of different Buddhist groups.	• The story of Amida Buddha is in the Sukhvata sutras
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